

AUTOMOBILES

FOCUS ON ROAD MAP



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► **AT THE ONGOING** G20 meetings during India's presidency, the country has pitched itself as a hub for the manufacture of fast electric chargers, electric vehicle (EV) batteries and battery recycling. To emphasise its commitment, the Indian government has set aggressive targets of EV sales penetration of 40 per cent for buses, 30 per cent for private cars, 70 per cent for commercial vehicles and 80 per cent for two-wheelers by 2030.

Industry players say that while the targets are clear, the road map is unclear. "One has to very closely watch for that road map because we cannot afford to derail the process as far as EV adoption is concerned," says Sohinder Gill, Director General of the industry body Society of Manufacturers of Electric Vehicles (SMEV). The country has huge potential in the global EV manufacturing ecosystem, but the real question is whether execution will match this potential. By 2030, India would require 500 gigawatt hours of EV batteries.

Gill says the G20 summit is all about reconfirming India's determination. "But after the G20, we have to make sure that those commitments are met. Our goal is very clear but the road map is chequered. It has to be a complete consortium of industry players; it cannot just be left to [polymakers]," he says. He warns that India is falling short on some targets. "The NITI Aayog had set a target of 100 per cent electrification in two- and three-wheelers by 2030. But today we're at less than 5 per cent," he says.

According to Jeetender Sharma, Founder & MD of Okinawa Autotech, driving positive change and empowering the future is the end goal. "As the G20 shapes global policies, we see tremendous opportunities for the growth of the auto sector, allowing our country to demonstrate its strength to the world. With the Indian automobile industry growing exponentially, we are confident of the positive changes that will lead to a new path for the entire industry," he says.

— Prerna Lidhoo

METALS

HEAVY METAL THUNDER

► **THE METALS SECTOR** feels that India can push the decarbonisation and green steel agenda as the G20 President. "India can set aspirational goals with a focus on processes wherein policy intervention and R&D is required," says Vipul Prasad, Founder and CEO of Magadh Capital Advisors. "There is a lot happening in the sector in terms of hydrogen-based output as a part of the industry's attempts to lower its carbon footprint. The focus will be on green steel and one could see clear long-term goals."

India's stance and that of Indian steel producers plays an important role as they are big globally. "We are cognisant of our responsibility as the world transitions to a low-carbon future. Our decarbonisation road map enables us to track our progress against well-defined targets for 2030,"

Indian steel producers' stance on green steel is important as they are big global players

says Prabodha Acharya, Group Chief Sustainability Officer of JSW Group. "The aim is to phase out thermal coal in steel making". Interestingly, some analysts say it is too early to say if the presidency will bring any direct benefits for the sector. "Each country will put its best foot forward. Yes, the Indian government is trying its best but there will not be much change in the broad direction," says an analyst.

— Ashish Rukhaiyar

